

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS - SIGHT RECORD FORM

Red 2/18/01 upl

NEW STATE RECORD _____ UNUSUAL RECORD _____

Species: Ruddy Turnstone (*Arenaria interpres*)**Date:** 6 May 2000**Number seen:** one**Sex:** ?**Plumage:** Alternate**Locality:** John Martin Res.**Elevation:** ~3851'**Nearest town:** Hasty**County:** Bent**Time observed:** ~19:30**Duration of observation:** ~2 minutes

Description: I heard about a Ruddy Turnstone at John Martin while I was traveling to Comanche NG with a couple friends from out-of-town. So, we hurried to get to the reservoir before it got dark - and made it. After a bit of searching of the island on which it had been earlier in the day, we found the bird and watched it a short while.

The bird was obviously a Ruddy Turnstone in Alternate, as there is really nothing at all similar. It was a largish, plump shorebird foraging on the shore of the pebbly island. It had a whitish head with a strong, complex, black pattern involving a line through the eye from the forehead and then turning down to and meeting with the posterior end of a malar stripe. There was also a couple (one thin and short, the other wide and long) nape/back-of-neck bars. The wings were mostly reddish-orange, with a wide, black bar on the coverts, and the upper back was blackish. The lower back and rump were white with contrastingly-black uppertail coverts. The tail was white basally and black subterminally. The underparts were white with a bold, black, complex chest band. The eyes and bill were dark and the legs were bright orange and fairly thick.

Similar species eliminated by description: There really is nothing similar - not even Black Turnstone, which has no reddish-orange in its plumage.

Describe the bird's song and call, if given, including method of delivery (i.e. from perch, in flight, duration): none heard

What is your prior experience with this and similarly-appearing species? I have seen 1000s of Ruddy Turnstones and 100s of Black Turnstones.

Light conditions: sun to my right and slightly behind me

Optical equipment used: Leica 20-60x

Distance, and how estimated: estimated at ~250 meters

Other observers who saw the bird with you: Darin O'Brien and Jeff Schultz

Other observers who saw the bird independently: Mark Janos and others

If photographed, type of equipment and film: did not photograph

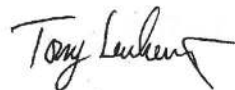
List books, illustrations, recordings, other birders, etc. consulted and how this influenced your identification:

a) at time of observation: none

b) after observation: none

Reporting observer: Tony Leukering

Signature:



Address: Rocky Mountain Bird Observatory, 14500 Lark Bunting Lane, Brighton, CO 80601

Date report was written: 3 January 2001 from brief notes written shortly after the sighting and from memory